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Registration No.

VISIONIAS

Assignment Code

46104254

Classroom Assignment Sheet

164630

Name: JAYANT KUMAWAT

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Subject: M.H. Batch: R33 Submission Date:

Question - Discuss the key provisions & implications of the Indian Councils Act 1909, also known as Morley-Minto Reforms, on Indian representation in governance. The Morley Minto Reforms represented the British attempt to reconcile growing Nationalist aspirations with Imperial control. Instead of democratizing governance, the reforms increased the political representation in carefully calibrated ways while ensuring British supremacy. In this sense, the Morley-Minto reforms sowed the seeds of communal politics via separate electorates.

Key provisions

① Separate electorate - was introduced ~~for~~ for Muslims with lower qualification in income for voting as compared to Hindus.

Additionally, the Muslims were given representation in central legislative council beyond their population percentage.

② Indirect Elections - The elections for non-official members also enabled the majority in provincial councils. The central council still possessed the majority of official members.

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③ Expansion of Councils - The number of elected members were increased in both provincial and central legislative councils.

④ Composition of Councils - 69 (CLC)

$$\begin{array}{ccc} 37 & + & 5 & + & 27 \\ \text{official} & & \text{Nominated} & & \text{Non-official members} \\ \text{members} & & & & \text{who will be elected.} \end{array}$$

Moreover, the seats in central leg. council (CLC) were reserved for muslims, British capitalists, Landlords etc.

⑤ Appointment of Indian in Governor general (G.G.) legislative council. Satyendra Prasad Sinha was the 1st Indian to join G.G. - executive council.

⑥ Legislative powers - Indian council members were allowed to do discussion on separate budget items, also enabled to ask supplementary questions.

Implications on Indian representation

① The role of Indians in the councils were close to that of an advisory body.

② Limited Franchise - Many Indians and women lacked voting rights and political representation.

It was seen as a mixed constitutionalism with autocracy.

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	Context	Content	Structure - presentation	Language	Word limit	Overall performance
Excellent						
Good						
Average						

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Question-

Implications on Indian National movement

- ① The reforms severely constrained the Indian National Congress (INC) as the communal politics took precedence.
- ② Major victory for Muslim League - It supported the two nation theory and the climax was witnessed decades later in the demand of a separate state - Pakistan.
- ③ The reforms nurtured separatism in India.
"In giving separate electorates, we are sowing dragon teeth, the harvest will be bitter"
— Mosley.

Thus, the Mosley Minis reforms showed a dual character of British constitutional policy in India.
Incremental political reforms while ensuring colonial supremacy + transforming constitutional reforms into instruments of Imperial politics.